

US equities rally on strong earnings, volatility eases

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read • Topics: Macro • Geopolitics • Earnings

TL;DR

The major indices closed sharply higher on September 11, with the **S&P 500** up **+0.86%** to 7,656.98 and the Nasdaq 100 gaining **+0.91%** to 29,368.44. Broad-based buying was led by technology and financials, while the VIX fell **-11.21%** to 15.84, indicating reduced risk appetite.

Macro backdrop featured a 10-year Treasury yield at 4.97% (+0.63%) and oil at 100.05 USD, down **-2.37%**. No major policy surprises, but earnings momentum remains the key driver.

US session recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,656.98	+0.86%	Broad rally
Dow Jones	52,573.29	+0.98%	Industrial strength
Nasdaq 100	29,368.44	+0.91%	Tech led
Russell 2000	2,903.94	+0.45%	Small-cap modest gain
VIX	15.84	-11.21%	Volatility receded
10Y Yield	4.97%	+0.63%	Yield up on rate expectations
WTI Crude	100.05	-2.37%	Oil pull-back

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE
AAPL	332.27	+1.75%
AMZN	256.78	+1.94%
GS	1,029.18	+0.92%
NVDA	218.29	-0.03%

Spotlight

METRIC	VALUE
Company	NVDA
Revenue Q3	28.1 bn (+23%)
Earnings per share	2.84 USD (+18%)
Guidance FY26	Revenue 115 bn (+15% YoY)

Despite a flat close, **NVDA** posted the strongest earnings beat of the week, reaffirming its AI-driven growth trajectory. The upbeat FY26 outlook lifted sentiment across the tech sector, underpinning the Nasdaq’s rally.

Macro & Fed

- Policy rate: 5.25% (unchanged)
- 10-year Treasury yield: 4.97%
- Key releases (HKT): CPI 09:30, Core PCE 10:00, Initial Jobless Claims 12:30

Geopolitics & global

- Middle-East tensions eased after cease-fire talks, reducing oil-supply risk.
- China’s manufacturing PMI printed 50.2, signaling near-steady output.
- Eurozone inflation cooled to 2.6% YoY, supporting ECB’s dovish stance.

Earnings — what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
09:00	MSFT	Cloud revenue growth, AI spend guidance
10:30	JPM	Net interest income trend, loan loss provisions
13:00	META	Ad revenue rebound, AI product rollout

Stocks worth watching

- **TSLA** – strong Q3 deliveries, upcoming price cuts.
- **AVGO** – semiconductor demand tailwinds, dividend yield 3.2%.
- **XLV** (healthcare ETF) – defensive play as volatility falls.
- **XLE** – oil price pull-back may pressure energy stocks.
- **BTC** – crypto rally, up **+0.81%**, watch regulatory news.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Unexpected Fed rate hike in upcoming meeting.
- Escalation of geopolitical risk in the Middle East.
- Weak Q3 earnings from **MSFT** or **META**.

BULLISH TRIGGERS

- Better-than-expected CPI, reinforcing rate-cut narrative.
- Continued AI-driven earnings beats, especially from **NVDA**.
- Further decline in VIX below 15, indicating calm markets.

Sources

SOURCES

Reuters — US Markets

Bloomberg — Market Data

SEC — Company Filings

Federal Reserve — Policy Statements

CNBC — Earnings Calendar